Water Dispenser

Category: **Hospitality & Housekeeping** Type: **Full SOP** Priority: **High** 1 labs

Covers these lab items: Water Dispenser / Cooler

What it is used for

A water dispenser or cooler provides drinking water at ambient, chilled, or heated temperature depending on its design. Correct installation, sanitation, and temperature control help maintain water quality and safe operation.

Main parts

- Water bottle holder or inlet connection
- Cold-water reservoir and cooling system if fitted
- Hot-water reservoir and heating element if fitted
- Dispensing taps or push buttons
- Drip tray and drain arrangement
- Power cable, thermostat, and indicator lights

Before you start

1. Read the manufacturer's instructions and identify the dispenser's hot, cold, and ambient-water functions.
2. Inspect the body, taps, bottle support, power cable, and water connections for damage or leaks.
3. Confirm that the unit is positioned on a stable, ventilated surface away from heat sources.
4. Clean and sanitize the reservoir and water-contact parts according to the approved procedure.
5. Use a sealed, approved drinking-water bottle or a verified potable-water supply.
6. After installation or cleaning, allow the unit to settle and cool or heat as specified before dispensing.

How to use

1. Install the bottle or connect the approved water supply according to the model instructions.
2. Ensure all water connections are secure and the bottle is seated correctly.
3. Switch on the cooling or heating functions only after the required water level is present.
4. Allow the water to reach the specified operating temperature.
5. Place a suitable cup beneath the selected dispensing tap.
6. Operate the tap or button and collect the required amount of water.
7. Close the tap fully and check for drips or leakage.
8. Empty and clean the drip tray when needed.
9. Switch off the unit before cleaning external surfaces or carrying out approved routine care.
10. Record sanitation or maintenance checks according to the facility procedure.

⚠ Safety

- Keep the power plug, cable, and electrical components dry and away from standing water.
- Do not touch the hot-water outlet or dispense hot water where children can reach it unsupervised.
- Never operate a heating function without the required water level.
- Use only potable water and approved food-contact cleaning products.
- Disconnect power before cleaning internal parts or servicing the unit.
- Do not use the dispenser if the cable, plug, taps, or reservoir are damaged or leaking.

Care & storage

- Clean and sanitize water-contact parts at the frequency specified by the facility procedure.
- Empty and clean the drip tray regularly to prevent residue and microbial growth.
- Inspect the water bottle, inlet connection, taps, and seals for leaks or contamination.
- Maintain the cooling and heating systems according to the manufacturer's schedule.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Using an unsealed or contaminated bottle can compromise drinking-water quality.
- Switching on the heater before confirming adequate water can damage the unit.
- Leaving the drip tray dirty can cause odours and microbial growth.
- Using harsh or unapproved chemicals can contaminate water-contact surfaces.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.